Northstar Technologies — Remote Work Policy

Document ID: HR-POL-007
Department: Human Resources and Operations
Version: 1.0
Effective Date: January 1, 2026

1. Purpose

This policy establishes the requirements and expectations for remote and hybrid work at Northstar Technologies.

The policy aims to support flexible working arrangements while maintaining productivity, effective collaboration, information security, employee well-being, and business continuity.

It defines eligibility considerations, approval procedures, communication expectations, equipment requirements, and responsibilities for employees working outside company offices.

2. Scope

This policy applies to employees whose roles permit remote or hybrid work and whose arrangements have been authorized by the company.

Remote work means performing assigned duties from an approved location outside a company office.

Hybrid work means dividing working time between an approved remote location and a company office or another authorized work location.

Not every role is suitable for remote work. Eligibility depends on job responsibilities, operational requirements, security considerations, performance expectations, and applicable employment arrangements.

Contractors and other nonemployee workers must follow the remote-work requirements established in their agreements and any applicable company procedures.

3. Eligibility and Approval

Employees must obtain approval before beginning a regular remote or hybrid work arrangement.

Managers evaluate requests based on:

- The nature of the employee's responsibilities.
- The need for in-person collaboration or physical presence.
- Expected performance and service requirements.
- Information security and confidentiality risks.
- Team coordination and business continuity.
- Applicable employment requirements.

Employees should submit requests through the process established by Human Resources or their department.

Approval must be documented through the company's designated process.

A temporary arrangement approved for a specific period does not automatically establish a permanent remote-work entitlement.

The company may review or modify arrangements when business requirements, role responsibilities, or other relevant circumstances change, subject to applicable law and contractual obligations.

4. Approved Work Location

Employees must perform remote work from a location authorized under their employment arrangements.

The work location should provide a reasonably safe, reliable, and private environment suitable for the employee's duties.

Employees must notify their manager when a significant or extended change of work location could affect security, availability, legal requirements, or operational arrangements.

Working from another country or a location outside the employee's approved jurisdiction requires prior review and written authorization. Such arrangements may create tax, employment, immigration, privacy, or information security implications.

Employees must not assume that approval to work remotely within their normal location also permits international remote work.

5. Working Hours and Availability

Remote employees must follow their agreed working schedule and any applicable working-time requirements.

Employees are expected to be available during designated working hours, attend required meetings, respond to reasonable work communications, and notify their manager when they will be unavailable.

Employees must record working time when required by their role, employment arrangements, or applicable law.

Flexible scheduling may be permitted when approved by the manager and compatible with team and business needs.

Remote work does not eliminate applicable requirements concerning breaks, overtime authorization, attendance, or time recording.

Employees should communicate schedule changes in advance whenever practical.

6. Communication and Collaboration

Effective communication is essential for remote and hybrid teams.

Employees must use approved company communication tools for work-related discussions, meetings, and document sharing.

Team members should keep calendars current, attend scheduled meetings, and provide timely updates about progress, blockers, and changing priorities.

Meetings should have a clear purpose and include the participants needed to make decisions or complete the work.

Employees should document important decisions and action items in appropriate shared workspaces so that colleagues can access relevant information.

Managers are responsible for establishing reasonable communication practices that support collaboration without creating unnecessary interruptions.

7. Performance and Productivity

Remote employees are subject to the same role-related performance expectations and professional standards as employees working in company offices.

Performance should be evaluated using relevant outcomes, deliverables, service quality, collaboration, and other appropriate measures rather than physical presence alone.

Employees must complete assigned responsibilities within agreed timelines and raise concerns when workload, technical problems, or other circumstances threaten delivery.

Managers should establish clear priorities, provide feedback, and address performance concerns through normal management procedures.

Remote work must not be used to avoid required responsibilities, meetings, or reasonable coordination with colleagues.

8. Equipment and Technology

Employees must use company-approved devices, software, and access methods when performing company work.

Company-issued equipment must be used responsibly and protected from damage, theft, unauthorized access, and misuse.

Employees must not install unauthorized applications, disable required security controls, or share company devices with unauthorized individuals.

Technical problems affecting the employee's ability to work must be reported promptly to IT or the designated support channel.

The company determines which equipment, peripherals, software licenses, and technical support are provided according to the employee's role and applicable arrangements.

Employees must obtain approval before purchasing equipment or services for which they expect company reimbursement.

9. Information Security and Confidentiality

Remote employees must comply with the company's IT Security Policy and all applicable data protection requirements.

Employees must:

- Lock their screens when leaving devices unattended.
- Use approved authentication and remote-access methods.
- Protect passwords and authentication codes.
- Store business information in approved systems.
- Avoid discussing confidential matters where unauthorized individuals may overhear.
- Verify recipients before sharing sensitive information.
- Report suspected security incidents immediately.

Confidential documents should not be left visible or accessible to household members, visitors, or other unauthorized individuals.

Employees must not transfer confidential company information to personal email accounts, unapproved cloud services, or unauthorized storage devices.

Public Wi-Fi networks should be avoided for sensitive work unless the required security measures are in place.

10. Home Workspace and Safety

Employees are responsible for maintaining a remote workspace that is reasonably safe and suitable for their duties.

The workspace should have adequate lighting, appropriate seating, sufficient ventilation, and an arrangement that reduces avoidable ergonomic risks.

Employees should take regular breaks and adjust their workstation to support comfort and safe working practices.

Potential hazards that could affect the employee's ability to work safely should be addressed promptly.

Employees must report work-related injuries or safety incidents through the appropriate company procedure.

The company may provide ergonomic guidance or other resources according to available programs and applicable legal requirements.

11. Expenses and Reimbursement

Remote-work expenses are governed by the applicable company reimbursement procedures, employment arrangements, and legal requirements.

Employees must obtain approval before incurring expenses for equipment, internet services, office supplies, or other items when approval is required.

Reimbursement claims must include the required receipts, business justification, and supporting documentation.

Personal expenses are not automatically reimbursable simply because they are incurred while working remotely.

Employees should contact their manager or Finance when they are uncertain whether a proposed expense qualifies for reimbursement.

12. Meetings and Office Attendance

Employees with hybrid arrangements must follow the office attendance schedule or other in-person requirements established for their role.

Managers may request in-person attendance for activities such as team planning, training, customer meetings, equipment maintenance, or other legitimate business needs.

Where advance notice is practical, employees should be informed of required office attendance with reasonable notice.

Employees must communicate scheduling conflicts promptly and follow the established process for requesting adjustments.

An approved remote-work arrangement does not automatically exempt an employee from reasonable, role-related in-person requirements.

13. Business Continuity and Technical Outages

Employees must notify their manager when an internet outage, power failure, equipment malfunction, or other disruption materially affects their ability to work.

Employees should use approved alternatives when available and appropriate.

If a disruption cannot be resolved promptly, the manager and employee should agree on practical next steps, which may include working from an approved alternative location, adjusting the schedule, or coordinating with IT.

Employees must not use unapproved public computers or insecure networks to access company systems as a workaround.

Significant disruptions affecting multiple employees or business-critical services must be escalated through the relevant support process.

14. Employee Well-Being and Boundaries

Northstar Technologies encourages employees to maintain reasonable boundaries between work and personal time.

Employees should take applicable breaks, use eligible leave, and communicate workload concerns when working arrangements become unsustainable.

Managers should avoid creating unnecessary expectations of availability outside agreed working hours, subject to legitimate operational requirements and applicable law.

Remote work should support effective performance and employee well-being rather than result in continuous availability or avoidable isolation.

Employees who need support with workplace challenges should contact their manager or Human Resources.

15. Changes, Reviews, and Termination of Arrangements

Remote and hybrid arrangements may be reviewed periodically to confirm that they remain appropriate for the role and business.

Employees must request approval before making a material change to an established arrangement, including a permanent change of work location or schedule.

The company may modify or end an arrangement when business needs, role responsibilities, performance concerns, security requirements, or other relevant factors justify a change, subject to applicable law and contractual obligations.

Managers should communicate decisions clearly and coordinate with Human Resources when required.

When an arrangement ends, employees must follow any instructions concerning office attendance, equipment, access, and administrative records.

16. Responsibilities

Employees are responsible for following approved work arrangements, meeting performance expectations, maintaining availability, protecting company information, and reporting relevant disruptions or incidents.

Managers are responsible for evaluating requests, setting clear expectations, coordinating team activities, monitoring outcomes, and reviewing arrangements when appropriate.

Human Resources is responsible for advising on eligibility, employment requirements, policy interpretation, and the documentation of arrangements when required.

Information Technology is responsible for supporting approved technology, managing access controls, and providing guidance on secure remote access.

All employees must comply with applicable company policies and legal requirements regardless of where they work.

17. Policy Violations

Failure to comply with this policy may result in a review of the employee's remote-work arrangement or other corrective action in accordance with company procedures and applicable law.

Serious violations involving unauthorized disclosure, misuse of company equipment, falsification of working records, or deliberate circumvention of security controls may be escalated to the appropriate internal function.

Employees should raise questions about remote-work requirements with their manager or Human Resources before taking actions that may conflict with this policy.

18. Review and Updates

Human Resources and Operations are responsible for reviewing this policy periodically and coordinating updates when business requirements, working practices, technologies, or applicable legal obligations change.

Employees should consult the current approved version and follow any additional procedures communicated by the company.

Document Owner: Human Resources and Operations
Document ID: HR-POL-007
Version: 1.0

End of document.